

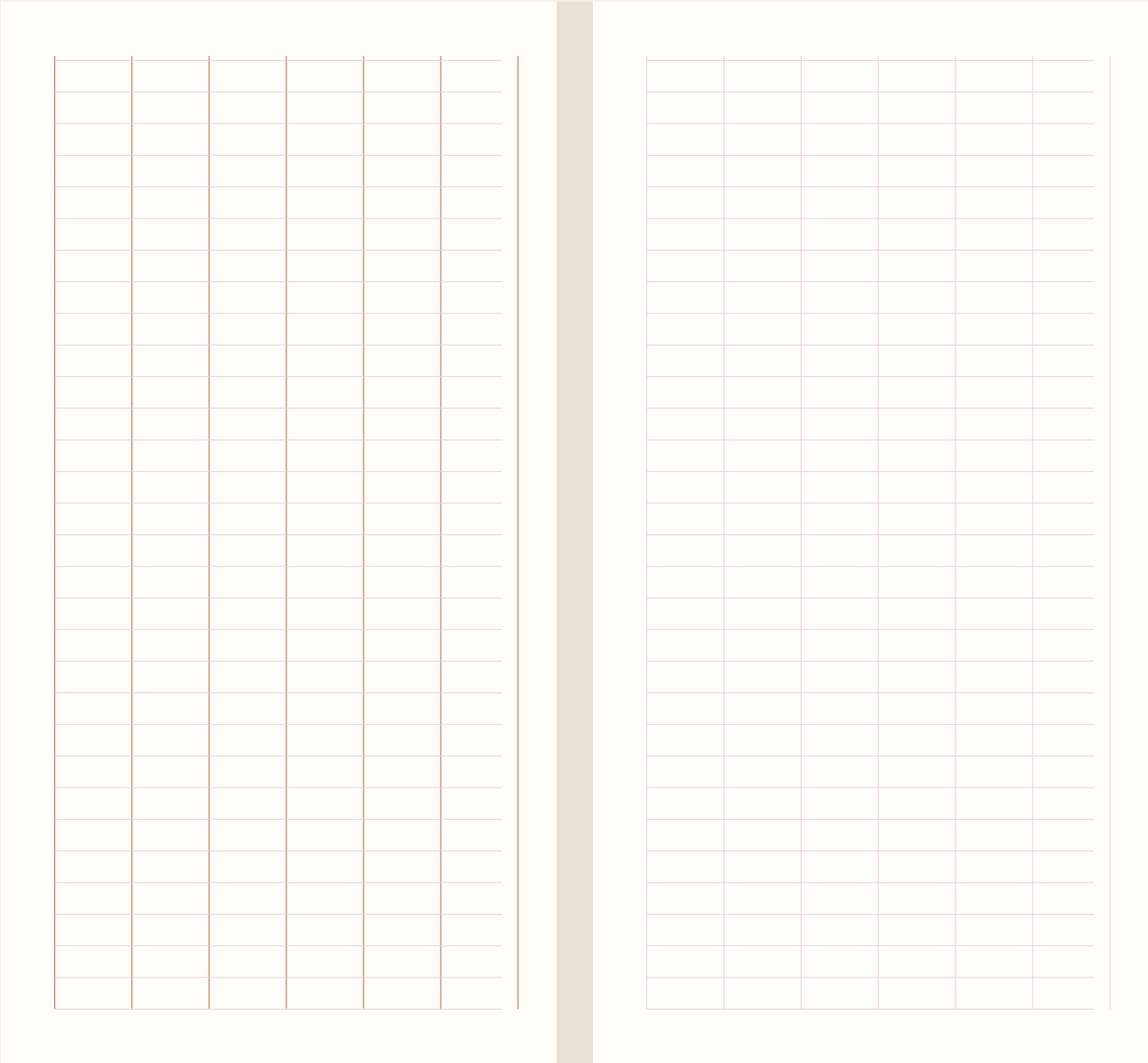
Common Ground

Grid, styles, masters, information design, and print workflow



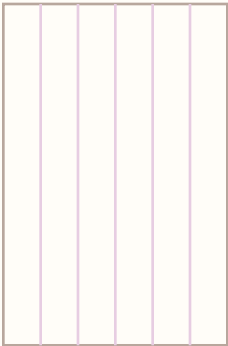
A 12-column spread system

Each page uses six columns; together, a spread forms twelve. A 14-point baseline creates vertical rhythm across body text, captions, chart labels, and folios.



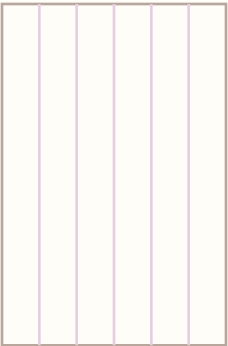
Eight master families

A



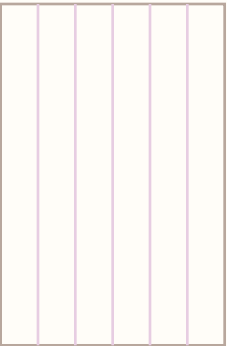
COVER
Full bleed image + title
lockup

B



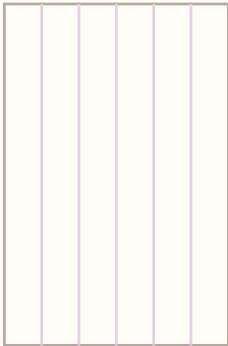
FRONT MATTER
Title, contents, editor note

C



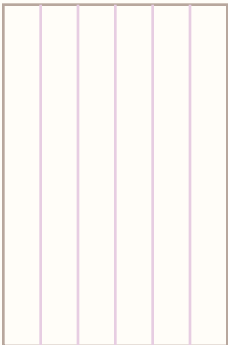
TEXT LEFT
Running head + outside
folio

D



TEXT RIGHT
Mirrored text master

E



DATA
Chart area + source note

F

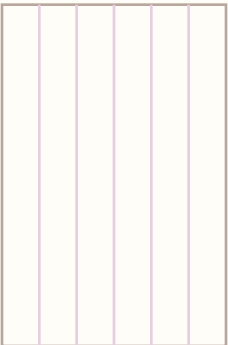
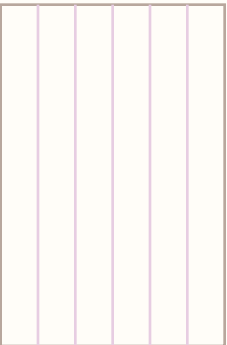


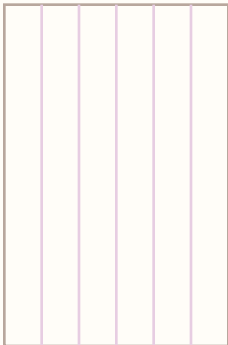
PHOTO ESSAY
Image-led spread + caption
rail

G



TIMELINE/TABLE
Structured information
page

H



BACK MATTER
Methodology, notes,
colophon

Two families, clear responsibilities

Aa

EB Garamond

Display, section titles, opening statements, and pull quotes. The serif carries narrative tone and establishes editorial pacing.

Aa

Inter

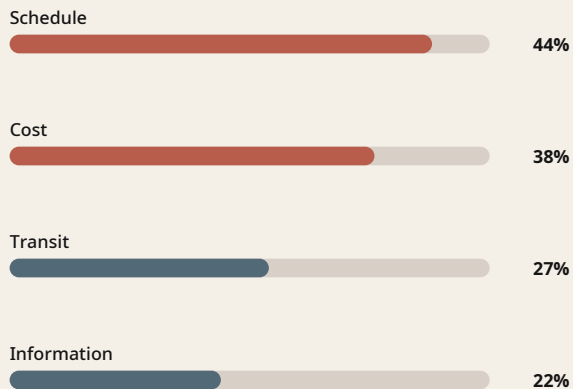
Body copy, captions, running heads, folios, chart labels, tables, notes, and production information. Tabular figures are used where numerical comparison matters.

Style	Font	Size / Leading	Use
Display	EBG	34–48 pt	Cover and chapter openings
Section title	EBG	28–34 / 30–36	Primary page headings
Lead	EBG	17 / 20	Opening summaries
Body	Inter	8.6 / 12.2	Long-form reading
Caption	Inter	6.7 / 8.7	Image and chart notes
Running head	Inter Medium	6.2	Navigation
Folio	Inter Medium	6.2	Outside page number

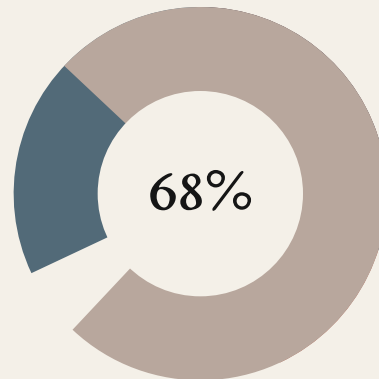
Charts should answer one question

The data language uses a limited palette, direct labels, tabular figures, explicit source notes, and short annotations. Decorative effects are removed unless they improve comparison.

Horizontal comparison



Part-to-whole



Timeline



Direct labels reduce legend-hunting. Source and status notes distinguish public facts from illustrative data.

Photography behaves like evidence

Images are cropped for a single focal action, duotoned to preserve system coherence, and paired with captions that explain what the reader should notice.



FULL-BLEED



PORTRAIT CROP

CAPTION RAIL

Build the last 10% into the file

TRIM

8.5 × 11 in

BLEED

0.125 in

BINDING

Perfect-bound concept

COLOR

CMYK target

IMAGES

300 ppi effective

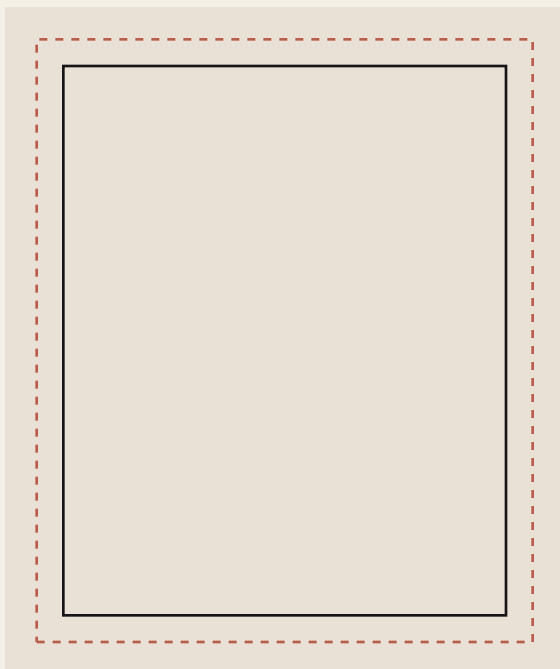
EXPORT

PDF/X-4 target

BLEED

TRIM

SAFE AREA



Preflight checklist

- ☒ Linked images current
- ☒ Fonts embedded or packaged
- ☒ Bleed applied to full-bleed assets
- ☒ Overset text resolved
- ☒ Widows and orphans reviewed
- ☒ Page order and folios verified
- ☒ Table values checked against source
- ☒ PDF preset and output intent confirmed

A clean file is part of the design

PROPOSED INDESIGN PACKAGE

Common_Ground/

01_InDesign/

Common_Ground_v05.indd

Common_Ground_v05.idml

02_Links/

Photography/

Charts/

Logos/

03_Deliverables/

Screen_PDF/

Print_PDF/

Proofs/

04_Archive/

REFLECTION

The publication is strongest when the design changes pace without changing rules. The grid, running navigation, and paragraph styles create continuity; image scale, white space, and information density create rhythm.

Next production step: rebuild the finished report natively in InDesign, package the links, verify paragraph and character styles, run preflight, export a PDF/X-4 file, and order a bound color proof.



CG